

Lesson 19: “Thy Faith Hath Saved Thee”

Purpose: To help us develop greater faith in Heavenly Father and Jesus Christ.

1. Jesus presents the parable of the unjust judge and the widow.

- [Luke 18:1-8](#) The parable of the unjust judge and the widow

→ 1. Elder James E. Talmage

What does it mean to pray always? → 2. Elder Neal A. Maxwell

What blessings can come to us when we pray always?

How is persevering in prayer an act of faith?

What should we do if we have persevered in prayer and feel we have not received an answer?

→ 3. Elder Richard G. Scott

→ 4. Truman G. Madsen

What have you learned as you have persevered in prayer?

2. A blind man demonstrates his faith and is healed by Jesus.

- [Luke 18:35-43](#) Jesus heals a blind man because of his faith

→ 5. Matthew Cowley

How did the blind man show that he had faith in the Lord?

How have you been blessed as you have exercised faith in Jesus Christ?

How did the man show gratitude when he received his sight?

How can we show gratitude to the Lord?

3. Jesus is received in Zacchaeus’s home.

- [Luke 19:1-10](#) Zacchaeus climbs a tree to see Jesus over the crowd

“The Jews generally disliked the publicans and considered them to be traitors and sinners.” (*Lesson Manual*, 79)

What can we do to receive the Savior joyfully into our homes?

How did Jesus’ response to Zacchaeus differ from the response of the others?

“Many people shunned Zacchaeus because of his profession as a publican.”

([Luke 19:2, 7](#); Bible Dictionary, “[Publicans](#),” 755)” (*Lesson Manual*, 79)

In what ways do we sometimes make similar judgments against others?

→ 5. Gayle M. Clegg

What can we learn from Jesus’ example in this account?

Why is it important for us not to exclude others or think we are better than they are?

How can we overcome unkind feelings against others?

→ 6. Elder Joe J. Christensen

4. Jesus raises Lazarus from the dead.

- [John 11:1-54](#) Lazarus is raised from the dead

“Soon after Jesus went to Zacchaeus’s home, he received a message from his friends Mary and Martha that their brother Lazarus, who was also Jesus’ dear friend, was sick ([John 11:1-5](#)). Two days later, Jesus directed his disciples to go with him to Bethany, the city in Judea where Mary, Martha, and Lazarus lived ([John 11:6-7](#)).

“When Jesus returned to Bethany, Lazarus had been dead for four days ([John 11:17](#)).” (*Lesson Manual*, 79)

• [John 11:20-27](#) **What impresses you about Martha’s testimony of Christ’s mission?**

• [John 11:33-35](#) **How does this account influence your feelings about Jesus?**

• [John 11:39-40](#) “Martha’s faith seemed weak when Jesus asked that the stone be removed.” (*LM*, 79)

How did Jesus help her?

What can we learn from this about what the Lord expects of us?

• [John 11:41-44](#) Jesus raises Lazarus from the tomb

“Jesus had already raised two people from the dead ([Mark 5:22-24](#), [35-43](#); [Luke 7:11-17](#)).” (*Lesson Manual*, 80)

How was raising Lazarus from the dead different from the previous two miracles?

• [John 11:45-54](#) **What effect did this miracle have on the people who witnessed it?**

How does this miracle strengthen your faith in the Savior?

(*The Life and Teachings of Jesus and His Apostles: Course Manual (Religion 211-212).*)

Next Week: New Testament Lesson 20: “[Woe unto You,... Hypocrites](#)”

[Matthew 21-23](#); [John 12:1-8](#)

➡ **1. Elder James E. Talmage:** “Jesus did not indicate that as the wicked judge finally yielded to supplication so would God do; but He pointed out that if even such a being as this judge, who ‘feared not God, neither regarded man,’ would at last hear and grant the widow’s plea, no one should doubt that God, the Just and Merciful, will hear and answer.” (*Jesus the Christ*, 38th ed. [1970], 436)

➡ **2. Elder Neal A. Maxwell:** “Prayer, in fact, is to be a reflection of our attitude toward God and life. In this sense, we can always be praying. (Luke 18:1.)

“Clearly, however, since praying is a part of living, if we are not living righteously the quality of our prayers will be affected.” (*All These Things Shall Give Thee Experience*, 92-93)

➡ **3. Elder Richard G. Scott:** “It is a mistake to assume that every prayer we offer will be answered immediately. Some prayers require considerable effort on our part. . . .

When we explain a problem and a proposed solution [to our Heavenly Father], sometimes He answers yes, sometimes no. Often He withholds an answer, not for lack of concern, but because He loves us—perfectly. He wants us to apply truths He has given us. For us to grow, we need to trust our ability to make correct decisions. We need to do what we *feel* is right. In time, He will answer. He will not fail us.” (“[Learning to Recognize Answers to Prayers](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1989, 30-31)

➡ **4. Truman G. Madsen:** “They say it in one way or another, those who really know about prayer: Only yearning prayer gets through.

“But there are three kinds of yearning.

“*We yearn when we mean what we say.* But is that enough when we are asking the impossible, or when what we are asking is, if we could only see, not for our good?

“*We yearn when we care terribly.* But is that enough when what we care for, however desperately, is a fist-shaking fixation that presumes God visions less of what is needed than we?

“*We yearn, finally, when we do not only mean and care intensely, but when at the core we are as anxious to listen as to ask.* We yearn when we will abide counsels already given and to respond to him and his way in his way.

“So long as we are set in our uninspired desires, not moldable, we must break our hearts before we can pray from them. So need we wonder why the heavens are often like brass over our heads?

“Humble prayer is the beginning of communication with the highest of personalities—God and his Son Jesus Christ—of higher ways of seeing and feeling, as it were, through their eyes.” (*Christ and the Inner Life, Second Edition*, (Salt Lake City: Bookcraft, 1978) 15-16)

➡ **5. Elder Matthew Cowley:** [the people of the Pacific islands] “... live close to God. They have some kind of power. I guess it is just because they accept miracles as a matter of course. They never doubt anything. . . .” (“[Miracles](#),” *Ensign*, October 2004, 44-46)

In this classic talk, Elder Cowley recounted the story of healing a boy who had been blind since birth; the healing of a woman, not a member, in the hospital dying of tuberculosis; and of witnessing a dead man being prepared for burial, who was raised from the dead.

➡ **6. Gayle M. Clegg:** After a week of heavy rains, the Cleggs pulled off a country road to enjoy the cherry blossoms and “felt the car’s tires sink into the wet, soft mud.”

She wrote, “All of our attempts to drive back onto the center of the road only pushed us farther down until the quicksand-like mud was above the car’s hubcaps. We were hopelessly stuck and hadn’t seen another car for some time.

“Suddenly we noticed a large dilapidated truck with six boisterous teenagers coming to a stop behind our car. As they jumped out of the truck, we noticed tattoos, chewing tobacco, and extreme hairstyles. My husband became fearful for our family’s safety and told us all to get into the car and lock the doors. The young men asked my husband if we needed help. My husband said no, we could easily handle the problem.

“The boys’ appearance looked more ominous than the car stuck in the mud up to the axle. The boys noticed the five small children and wife in the car as the “we” my husband was referring to and suggested that he get back into the car and start driving while they pushed. The wheels spun sheets of mud in every direction, covering the boys from head to toe while they pushed the car onto the pavement.

“My husband pulled money out of his wallet to pay the teenagers, but they refused and jumped back into the truck, saying they were happy to help a brother. They were gone before we could even thank them properly. . . . Physical coverings can impede seeing into the heart.

“... Jesus saw beyond the temporal coverings to the heart as He reached out to the tax collectors, forgave the debtors, and healed the sinners.” (“[Teaching Our Children to Accept Differences](#),” *Ensign*, June 2004, 43-44)

➡ **6. Elder Joe J. Christensen:** “There are those who wake up every morning dreading to go to school, or even to a Church activity, because they worry about how they will be treated. You have the power to change their lives for the better. . . . The Lord is counting on you to be a builder and give them a lift. Think less of yourself and more about the power you have to assist others, even those within your own family.” (“[The Savior is Counting on You](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1996, 39)